

SUPPLEMENTARY SHEET 1

Sustainable Development The Facts

Sustainable Development Defined

This is the most widely used definition of sustainable development accepted by the United Nations.

“Development which meets the needs of present generations without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs.” Our Common Future: Report of the World Commission on Environment and Development (The Brundtland Report), 1987



Eight Point Outline of Sustainable Development

Sustainable Activities	Unsustainable Activities
• Use materials in continuous cycles (Re-using materials either through natural process or recycling programs). • Use continuously reliable sources of energy. (Heat from the Earth's core, tides, the sun (nuclear fusion at a safe distance) and the wind and water which the sun sets in motion). • Come mainly from the qualities of being human (i.e. creativity, communication, coordination, appreciation, and spiritual and intellectual development).	• Require continual inputs of non-renewable resources (Resources available only in limited quantity. Metals, coal and oil are notable examples). • Use renewable resources faster than their rate of renewal (Renewable resources: grow and increase through natural processes; e.g. forests, fish stocks, ground water and soil fertility. The rate at which they are used $\leq$ the rate at which they grow or accumulate). • Cause cumulative degradation of the environment (Creating waste which nature cannot handle, or which cannot be absorbed as fast as we create it). • Require resources in quantities that undermine other people's well-being (People taking unfair advantage of others). • Lead to the extinction of other life forms (The loss of species means we also lose genetic possibilities for fighting disease, in people and in food crops, as well as potential new sources of food).



Where to go for Information



International Institute for Sustainable: Development Youth Source Book on Sustainable Development

<http://iisd.ca/youth/ysbk000.htm>

IISD is an organization that promotes the transition toward a sustainable future. It seeks to demonstrate how human ingenuity can be applied to improve the well-being of the environment, economy and society.

The Youth Sourcebook was written by an international working group to:

- increase their own awareness of sustainable development issues
- strengthen global youth cooperation and networks
- contribute to the implementation of Agenda 21, the global plan of action agreed to at the Earth Summit.

Conservation Education

http://na.fs.fed.us/spfo/ce/content/for_teachers/curriculum/index.cfm?AudienceToView=27

The Conservation Education program (CE) helps people of all ages understand and appreciate our country's natural resources and how to conserve those resources for future generations.

Environment Canada

<http://www.ec.gc.ca/>

Environment Canada's Internet resource for weather and environmental information. The Green Lane helps connect Canadians, exchange information and share knowledge for environmental decision-making.

Global Ed. Website

<http://globaled.ausaid.gov.au/secondary/casestud/index.html>

The Global Ed. Website is an education resource for students and teachers. It has information on a wide diversity of global issues including development economics, governance, HIV/AIDS, human rights, health, refugees, women, **the environment**, food security and agriculture.

What can you do?

We can become part of the sustainability movement and make it possible for everyone to secure their quality of life within the means of nature.



Also, we can use resources more efficiently by:

- Using energy-efficient lamps and other household products
- Composting and recycling
- Decreasing our consumption
- Buying fewer cars and other disposable products
- Educating ourselves and others.